

# YOUR SHOP.



1  
ONCE

WHERE WE SHOP .....

Main shop .....

Branch, or delivery .....

Shopping day ..... Slot or time .....

Loyalty card, and the account .....

Budget a week ..... A month .....

**Write your aisle order once, and the rest of this kit follows it**

Walk your shop in your head from the door to the till and number what you pass. Every list in here is then written in **that** order rather than in categories invented by somebody who has never been to your shop — which is the whole reason for walking back across the place for the thing you forgot.

THE AISLE ORDER, OURS ..... Door to till

- 1 ..... 2 .....
- 3 ..... 4 .....
- 5 ..... 6 .....
- 7 ..... 8 .....
- 9 ..... 10 .....
- 11 ..... 12 .....

THE OTHER PLACES .....

| SHOP | WHAT WE GET THERE | OFTEN |
|------|-------------------|-------|
|------|-------------------|-------|

|       |       |       |
|-------|-------|-------|
| ..... | ..... | ..... |
| ..... | ..... | ..... |
| ..... | ..... | ..... |
| ..... | ..... | ..... |

BOUGHT EVERY SINGLE TIME ..... The standing list

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

WHAT WE ALWAYS RUN OUT OF .....

.....

.....

.....

.....

WHO GOES .....

Usually .....

If nobody can .....

THE THREE RULES OF THIS SHOP ..... Ours

.....

.....

.....

# THE KITCHEN CHECK.

Week of \_\_\_\_\_



**Stand in front of the fridge with this page**

Almost everything bought twice is bought because nobody looked. Five minutes here, with the fridge open and the cupboard door open, is the difference between a list and a guess — and it is also where the week’s cooking decides itself, because what has to be used up comes first.

**USE FIRST** ..... Going over in the next three days

| WHAT  | BY WHEN | USED                     |
|-------|---------|--------------------------|
| _____ | _____   | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____   | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____   | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____   | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____   | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____   | <input type="checkbox"/> |

**FRIDGE — LOW OR GONE** .....

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

**FREEZER — WHAT IS ACTUALLY IN THERE** .....

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

**CUPBOARD — LOW OR GONE** ..... Page 8 has the levels

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

**HOUSEHOLD, CLEANING, PAPER** .....

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

**TOILETRIES, AND THE MEDICINE CABINET** .....

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

**PET, BABY, ANYTHING ELSE** .....

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

**ALREADY HAVE TOO MUCH OF** ..... Do not buy these again this week

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

# THE WEEK'S FOOD.

Week of \_\_\_\_\_



3  
WEEKLY

DINNERS ..... F from the freezer · S needs shopping

| DAY | WHAT WE ARE EATING | AT TABLE | F                        | S                        |
|-----|--------------------|----------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| Mon | _____              | _____    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Tue | _____              | _____    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Wed | _____              | _____    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Thu | _____              | _____    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Fri | _____              | _____    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Sat | _____              | _____    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Sun | _____              | _____    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

THE TWO NIGHTS NOBODY COOKS ..... Name them now

| NIGHT | WHAT HAPPENS INSTEAD |
|-------|----------------------|
| _____ | _____                |
| _____ | _____                |

BREAKFASTS AND LUNCHES TO COVER .....

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

Plan two fewer meals than you think

Seven dinners get planned, four get cooked, and the other three turn up on page 7 as a bag of salad and a packet of chicken thighs. Plan five, write the freezer night and the nobody-cooks night down as real plans rather than failures, and the waste log stops filling up.

COOKS FROM WHAT IS ALREADY HERE .....

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

NEEDS BUYING ..... These go onto page 4

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

COOKS TWICE ..... Make the double batch on purpose

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

WHO IS OUT THIS WEEK .....

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

# THE LIST, IN AISLE ORDER.

Week of \_\_\_\_\_



4  
WEEKLY

AISLE, FROM PAGE 1

QTY IN

1 \_\_\_\_\_

|       |       |                          |
|-------|-------|--------------------------|
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |

2 \_\_\_\_\_

|       |       |                          |
|-------|-------|--------------------------|
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |

3 \_\_\_\_\_

|       |       |                          |
|-------|-------|--------------------------|
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |

AISLE, FROM PAGE 1

QTY IN

4 \_\_\_\_\_

|       |       |                          |
|-------|-------|--------------------------|
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |

5 \_\_\_\_\_

|       |       |                          |
|-------|-------|--------------------------|
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |

6 \_\_\_\_\_

|       |       |                          |
|-------|-------|--------------------------|
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |



# THE BIG SHOP, AND THE TOP-UP.

Week of \_\_\_\_\_

**THE BIG SHOP** ..... Heavy, bulky, keeps — not fresh

| WHAT | SIZE | QTY | IN |
|------|------|-----|----|
|------|------|-----|----|

|       |       |       |                          |
|-------|-------|-------|--------------------------|
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |

Cleaning, paper, tins, rice and pasta, drinks, pet food, washing powder.  
None of it needs to be bought fresh and all of it is heavy, so it belongs in  
one trip a month rather than in the weekly basket where it quietly doubles  
the bill.

**WHERE THE BIG SHOP GOES** .....

Shop, and when \_\_\_\_\_

**NEVER WORTH BUYING BIG** ..... Goes off, or nobody likes it that much

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

**The top-up is where the money actually goes**

Three quick trips a week for bread and milk cost more than most households' meat budget, because nobody walks out of a shop with only bread and milk. If there is going to be a top-up, write it here first — and if the list is two items long, send whoever can go in and out without a basket.

**THE TOP-UP** ..... Bread, milk, fruit, salad

| WHAT | IN |
|------|----|
|------|----|

|       |                          |
|-------|--------------------------|
| _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |

**NEVER ORDERED ONLINE** ..... The things we want to choose ourselves

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

**SUBSTITUTIONS WE WILL ACCEPT** ..... And the ones we will not

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

# WHAT IT COSTS.

Week of \_\_\_\_\_



6  
MONTHLY

THIS MONTH'S SHOPS ..... Every one of them, including the top-ups

| DATE  | WHERE | SPENT | PLAN                     |
|-------|-------|-------|--------------------------|
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> |

BUDGET \_\_\_\_\_ SPENT \_\_\_\_\_ LEFT \_\_\_\_\_

The line that matters is not the big shop, it is the number of rows. Four shops a month and a full trolley beats eleven shops and a basket, every time.

## Compare per 100 g, not per packet

The shelf label carries a unit price in small print, and it is the only number on the shelf that tells the truth. The big box is often dearer per gram than the middle one, the offer is sometimes dearer than the plain shelf price, and the loose vegetables are almost always cheaper than the same vegetables in a bag.

WORKED OUT ONCE ..... Per 100 g, per litre, per wash

| WHAT  | SIZE  | PRICE | PER UNIT |
|-------|-------|-------|----------|
| _____ | _____ | _____ | _____    |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | _____    |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | _____    |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | _____    |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | _____    |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | _____    |
| _____ | _____ | _____ | _____    |

ALWAYS OWN-BRAND ..... Tested, no difference

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

NEVER OWN-BRAND ..... For us, worth the money

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

ONLY WHEN IT IS ON OFFER .....

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

Week of



7  
MONTHLY

## THE LOG

Date, what, and why — one line

DATE \_\_\_\_\_

## WHAT

## WHY IT WAS NOT EATEN

## The bin is the cheapest place to look for money

Nothing on this page was bought carelessly. It was bought by somebody planning to eat well: the salad, the herbs, the yoghurts, the second bag of spinach. Keeping this page for one month changes what goes in the trolley more than any budget does, because you stop arguing with yourself about what you *should* eat and start buying what you actually ate.

SHOWS UP MORE THAN TWICE

**BUY LESS OF**

## BUY SMALLER, OR LOOSE

**FREEZE IT INSTEAD** ..... On the day it comes in

## WHAT WE ARE DOING DIFFERENTLY

The four honest reasons: bought too much, never got round to it, went off sooner than expected, nobody actually likes it. Write the real one.



8  
ONCE

Week of

You do not need to remember to buy rice. You need to know the number below which rice goes on the list — and then anybody in the house can write the list, not just the person who holds it all in their head. Fill this in once, in front of the open cupboard, and page 2 becomes a two-minute job.

- ☐ Everything is dated and named on the day it goes in
- ☐ Flat bags, standing up, not a pile
- ☐ One shelf or drawer is the eat-me-next shelf
- ☐ Leftovers get frozen the same evening, not on day three

[illegible]

# WHAT WE FORGOT.

Week of \_\_\_\_\_



THE FORGOT LIST ..... Tick it when it reaches page 1

| DATE  | WHAT WE FORGOT | ON P1                    |
|-------|----------------|--------------------------|
| _____ | _____          | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____          | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____          | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____          | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____          | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____          | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____          | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____          | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____          | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____          | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| _____ | _____          | <input type="checkbox"/> |

It is the same three or four things forever. Once a thing has been written here twice it belongs on the standing list on page 1, and then it stops being something anybody has to remember.

WHAT IS GOOD WHERE ..... Worth the separate trip

| SHOP  | WHAT  | PRICE |
|-------|-------|-------|
| _____ | _____ | _____ |
| _____ | _____ | _____ |
| _____ | _____ | _____ |
| _____ | _____ | _____ |
| _____ | _____ | _____ |

NOT WORTH IT HERE .....

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

TRY NEXT TIME .....

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

PRICES WORTH REMEMBERING ..... Know a real offer

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

NOTES .....

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_